

Intonation: Falling and Rising

Intonation means the rise and fall of the voice when speaking. It helps to show meaning, emotion, or attitude in speech. There are two main types of intonation patterns: falling and rising intonation.

1. Falling Intonation

The voice goes down at the end of a sentence.

It is used in:

Statements:

'n She is my teacher.

Commands:

'n Close the door.

Wh-questions:

'n Where are you going?

End of a conversation:

'n Goodbye.

Example ('):

> "I live in Lagos."

(The pitch falls at the end.)

2. Rising Intonation

The voice goes up at the end of a sentence.

It is used in:

Yes/No questions:

'n Are you coming?

Unfinished thoughts:

'n I bought apples, oranges, and...

Polite or uncertain statements:

'n Maybe later?

Example (ij):

> "Are you okay?"

(The pitch rises at the end.)

Type of Intonation	Voice Direction	Common Use	Example
Falling ' Down	Statements, commands, Wh-questions		Where is my book?
Rising ij Up	Yes/No questions, uncertainty		Do you like it?